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QUOTATIONS

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THE MEMOIRS OF MADAME DE MONTESPAN

By Madame de Montespan





Madame de Valliere



Madame de Maintenon



Moliere

All the death-in-life of a convent

*Always sold at a loss which must be
sold at a given moment*

*Ambition puts a thick bandage over the
eyes*

*And then he would go off, laughing in
his sleeve*

Armed with beauty and sarcasm

*Cannot reconcile themselves to what
exists*

*Conduct of the sort which cements and
revives attachments*

*Console me on the morrow for what had
troubled me to-day*

Cuddlings and caresses of decrepitude

*Depicting other figures she really
portrays her own*

*Domestics included two nurses, a
waiting-maid, a physician*

Extravagant, without the means to be so

*Grow like a dilapidated house; I am
only here to repair myself*

*Happy with him as a woman who takes her
husband's place can be*

Hate me, but fear me

He contradicted me about trifles

He was not fool enough for his place

*I myself being the first to make merry
at it (my plainness)*

*In the great world, a vague promise is
the same as a refusal*

*In Rome justice and religion always
rank second to politics*

*In ill-assorted unions, good sense or
good nature must intervene*

*In England a man is the absolute
proprietor of his wife*

*Intimacy, once broken, cannot be
renewed*

*It is easier to offend me than to
deceive me*

*Jealous without motive, and almost
without love*

*Kings only desire to be obeyed when
they command*

*Knew how to point the Bastille cannon
at the troops of the King*

*Laws will only be as so many black
lines on white paper*

*Love-affair between Mademoiselle de la
Valliere and the King*

Madame de Sevigne

*Madame de Montespan had died of an
attack of coquetry*

*Not show it off was as if one only
possessed a kennel*

*Permissible neither to applaud nor to
hiss*

Poetry without rhapsody

*Present princes and let those be
scandalised who will!*

Respectful without servility

Satire without bitterness

*Says all that he means, and resolutely
means all that he can say*

*She awaits your replies without
interruption*

*Situations in life where we are
condemned to see evil done*

Talent without artifice

That Which Often It is Best to Ignore

The King replied that "too much was too much"

The monarch suddenly enough rejuvenated his attire

The pulpit is in want of comedians; they work wonders there

Then comes discouragement; after that, habit

There is an exaggeration in your sorrow

These liars in surplice, in black cassock, or in purple

Time, the irresistible healer

Trust not in kings

Violent passion had changed to mere friendship

Weeping just as if princes had not got to die like anybody else

Went so far as to shed tears, his most difficult feat of all

What they need is abstinence, prohibitions, thwartings

When women rule their reign is always stormy and troublous

When one has seen him, everything is excusable

When one has been pretty, one imagines that one is still so

Wife: property or of furniture, useful to his house

Wish you had the generosity to show, now and again, less wit

*Women who misconduct themselves are
pitiless and severe*

*Won for himself a great name and great
wealth by words*

*Would you like to be a cardinal? I can
manage that*

*You know, madame, that he generally
gets everything he wants*

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